Save My Exams

GCSE · OCR · Computer Science

1 hour 16 questions

Ethical, Legal, Cultural & Environmental Impact

Ethical, Legal, Cultural & Environmental Impact

Impacts of Digital Technology on Wider Society / Legislation in Computer Science

Easy (3 questions)	/5
Medium (6 questions)	/25
Hard (7 questions)	/52
Total Marks	**/82**

Scan here to return to the course
or visit savemyexams.com

© 2026 Save My Exams, Ltd.

Easy Questions

1 Identify **two examples** of **ethical issues** in computing.

.....

..... **(2 marks)**

2 **State two primary offences** under the Computer Misuse Act (1990).

.....

..... **(2 marks)**

3 **State one disadvantage** of proprietary software.

..... **(1 mark)**

© 2026 Save My Exams, Ltd.

Medium Questions

1 **Tick (✓) one** box **on each row** to identify the legislation that would cover each of the given events.

Event	The Data Protection Act (2018)	Computer Misuse Act (1990)	Copyright Designs and Patents Act (1988)
A company transmits personal data to another company without the individual's permission.			
A school accidentally publishes their students' addresses on the school website.			
The interface for a piece of software is replicated by a rival company.			
A user leaves a computer logged on and another person leaves them a message on their desktop.			
A student guesses their teacher's password and accesses their computer account.			

(5 marks)

© 2026 Save My Exams, Ltd.

2 **Tick (✓) one box** in **each row** to show which legislation applies to each action.

Action	Data Protection Act 2018	Computer Misuse Act 1990	Copyright Designs and Patents Act 1988
Using a picture for the law company's new logo without the original creator's permission.			
A secretary accessing a lawyer's personal email account without permission.			
Making a copy of the latest Hollywood blockbuster movie and sharing it with a client.			
Storing customer data insecurely.			
A lawyer installing a key logger on the secretary's computer.			
Selling client's personal legal data to a marketing company without their permission.			

Fig. 2

(6 marks)

3 Layla has created an **educational game**, she is going to release it as **open source**.

Give **one benefit** and **one drawback** of Layla releasing her game as open source.

.....

..... **(2 marks)**

4 **Identify the legislation** that relates to the following scenarios:

Scenario	Legislation
A programmer wants to protect their work from being copied or distributed.	
A person logs into a computer without permission by guessing the password.	
A hacker gains access to a company's files over a network without permission	
A company collects data that it does not need about its customers.	

(4 marks)

5 (a) Fiona is a software engineer. She is creating a new version of a computer game she released three years ago.

Fiona is considering **selling the game online** and **not making it available physically in shops**.

Describe the environmental impact of Fiona's decision.

.....

..... **(2 marks)**

(b) Fiona releases her game under a **proprietary licence**.

Explain why **a proprietary licence is a more appropriate** choice than **open source**.

.....

..... **(2 marks)**

6 (a) Marcus is a software developer who has created a mobile application for managing personal finances. He is considering **distributing the application exclusively through digital app stores** rather than **creating physical installation media or USB drives**.

Analyse the environmental impact of Marcus's decision to distribute his application digitally.

.....

..... **(2 marks)**

(b) Marcus decides to release his financial management application under a **proprietary licence** instead of making it **open source**.

Evaluate why **a proprietary licence provides better protection** for Marcus's business interests compared to **open source licensing**.

.....

..... **(2 marks)**

© 2026 Save My Exams, Ltd.

Hard Questions

1 Social networking websites use **artificial intelligence** (**AI**) to **monitor posts** from users.

Discuss the **positive** and **negative** uses of AI by social networking websites including:

- **Legal issues**
- **Ethical issues**
- **Privacy issues**

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... **(8 marks)**

© 2026 Save My Exams, Ltd.

2 People often want to buy the most up-to-date smartphones, even though the smartphone they own still works.

Discuss the impact of people wanting to **upgrade to the latest smartphone.**

In your answer, you might consider the impact on:

- **Smartphone users**
- **Cultural issues**
- **Ethical issues**
- **Environmental issues.**

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... **(8 marks)**

3 (a) A technology company brings out new, updated devices twice a year.

Describe the environmental impacts of the company bringing out **new devices twice a year**.

.....

..... **(2 marks)**

(b) **Describe the cultural impacts** of the company bringing out **new devices twice a year**.

.....

..... **(2 marks)**

4 A school asks its students to **bring in their own electronic devices** (e.g. tablets, laptops, mobile phones) to use in lessons instead of purchasing new equipment.

Discuss the issues surrounding students bringing their own devices. Include in your discussion:

- **Ethical issues**
- **Legal issues**
- **Privacy issues.**

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... **(8 marks)**

© 2026 Save My Exams, Ltd.

5 Daniel is a **medical researcher** trying to **find a cure for a diseas**e. He has a team of hundreds of people carrying out medical testing.

Recent developments in Artificial Intelligence (AI) mean that **a computer program could do the work of dozens of researchers in a much shorter time**. Daniel decides to **increase** his use of Artificial Intelligence.

Discuss the issues surrounding this decision. Consider the following in your answer:

- **Ethical issues**
- **Legal issues**
- **Cultural issues**

(8 marks)

6 A small island has 100 people living on it. The island has **just been connected to the Internet**, after previously having no Internet or mobile phone signal.

Discuss the impact on the island's inhabitants and businesses of getting access to the Internet.

In your answer you might consider the impact on:

- **Inhabitants**
- **Businesses**
- **Ethical issues**
- **Privacy issues**

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... **(8 marks)**

© 2026 Save My Exams, Ltd.

7 A computer programmer has developed a computer game that they want to release for users to download over the internet. The programmer needs to decide whether to release the game as open source or proprietary software.

Discuss the features, benefits and drawbacks of each type of licence for this program and make a recommendation to the programmer.

You should include the following in your answer:

- features of each licence
- legal and ethical issues of each licence
- benefits and drawbacks of each licence.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... **(8 marks)**